

Term Spring 2025 Instructors Debs, Alex (P)	Course GLBL 260 01/PLSC 130 01 - Nuclear Politics	Primary Dept PLSC	Primary Division Social Sciences	Enrolled: 49 Responded: 42
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#10 Summarize the strengths and weaknesses of the Teaching Fellow. In what ways was their teaching effective and in what ways could their teaching be improved?

Instructor(s): Trubowitz, Alexander

Responses for Instructor: 17
Declined to Answer Question: 5

Respondent	Answer
1826119	Very effective, easily guided us through discussions and got across all relevant points of information in the short period. Knew everyone's essay responses throughout semester to engage us in conversations about them in discussion
1826528	Sander was awesome! He took the effort to get his students well, which I think helped a lot in making the discussion section run smoothly and making me feel comfortable in sharing and speaking in section. His feedback on memos and midterms was very helpful and he gave concrete feedback on how to improve. His office hours were helpful and overall he was a great TF!
1826533	Great section TA, extremely knowledgeable about the subject and also seemed to be genuinely interested in student thoughts and ideas. The section structure encouraged participation and overall was a really good way to better understand the material.
1832072	Our sections in this course certainly stood out (positively!) from other sections I have had in the past. I think there was a good mix, especially towards the end, of recapping our reading and lecture material, as well as applying this to practice questions to help us develop the skills needed to answer those questions in our assignments and our exams. The teaching fellow made us all feel encouraged to share our views, always praising our insightful comments and pushing us to think critically about how these theories applied to real-world examples. We were also always constantly recapping the basics of the course, which made studying easier as certain initial concepts felt like second nature. Like the lectures, the sections were always light-hearted and engaging, and I have very few suggestions on how they could have been run differently. I also think the feedback provided was fair and helpful. I would have loved if we had discussed the expectations and requirements for some of the assignments in more detail in section, but overall, the Alexander was very effective with communicating key course concepts and helping his students feel engaged with the content!
1832343	Great teacher and smart
1833090	Chill guy who understands the content well. He is able to display both sides of issues clearly. He can improve by simply explaining concepts rather than trying to extract them out of students by asking broad questions.
1833849	Strengths: very prepared for each section; guided discussions effectively Weaknesses: None
1835228	Alexander was wonderful! He guided discussions well and always provided direct feedback on how to improve.
1836080	Sander is so knowledgeable when it comes to the subject matter and made me look forward to section every week. He provided such amazing feedback on my writing and I feel I genuinely improved my abilities because of him.
1840415	My TA was awesome. He did a super great job and was very helpful when needed.
1840432	Great tf, engaging lectures, helped summarize the content.
1840588	Alexander did an amazing job going over material in an engaging way and facilitating conversations that improved our understanding.
1840663	I always looked forward to sections with Sander because I knew I would leave with an even greater understanding of the course material. He was extremely knowledgeable about nuclear politics and consistently pushed students to better themselves and their arguments. I also enjoyed the way section meetings were structured, where we discussed and dissected specific prompts. I do not think Sander had any particular weaknesses.
1840844	Sander was phenomenal and led very engaging discussions. His feedback was very clear and always offered ample opportunities to meet during office hours.
1843355	an excellent, patient and academically challenging (in the best way) TF. i felt very lucky to be taught by him!

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#10 Summarize the strengths and weaknesses of the Teaching Fellow. In what ways was their teaching effective and in what ways could their teaching be improved?

Instructor(s): Trubowitz, Alexander

Responses for Instructor: 17

Declined to Answer Question: 5

Respondent	Answer
1848703	strengths: One of the best TF's I've ever had. Sander made every single student feel known/cared about from the very first discussion section meeting, and, throughout the semester, he smoothly balanced building our confidence in the subject matter while simultaneously pushing us past each of our comfort zones. He is deeply knowledgeable about the subject matter, and his passion for it is obvious. All of our work was returned very efficiently, and Sander gave detailed, insightful feedback. Sander is a natural teacher, and it was a pleasure to getting to learn from his this semester.
1866820	I am glad to have had Sander as my TF this semester! To begin, he was supportive. He encourage our participation in section, stretched our thinking, and was always willing to lend a hand had we forgotten a fact or found a question too difficult. Moreover, he was a great teacher. He helped us understand our class readings. Furthermore, he gave me some of the best feedback I have ever received on writing assignments. It is clear he takes teaching seriously and is committed also to making us better students, readings, writers, and thinkers. Section was helpful and enjoyable for us with Sander. He was amazing!

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Instructors				
Debs, Alex (P)				

#11 What is your overall assessment of the Teaching Fellow?

Instructor(s): Trubowitz, Alexander

Responses for Instructor: 21
Declined to Answer Question: 1

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
4.8 ±0.5	4.4 ±1.0	4.3 ±1.0	4.4 ±0.9

Choice Label	Counts
poor	0
fair	0
good	1
very good	2
excellent	18

Term Spring 2023 **Course** EP&E 363 01/GLBL 287 01/PLSC 387
01/SOCY 230 01 - Capitalism and Crisis **Primary Dept** PLSC **Primary Division** Social Sciences **Enrolled:** 53
Responded: 48

Instructors
Mares, Isabela (P)

#10 Summarize the strengths and weaknesses of the Teaching Fellow. In what ways was their teaching effective and in what ways could their teaching be improved?

Instructor(s): Trubowitz, Alexander

Responses for Instructor: 18
Declined to Answer Question: 4

Respondent	Answer
1647361	Sander is the man. In my four years at this school, he's far and away the best TA I've ever had. He helped us digest very complicated and dense readings into understandable and engaging concepts, and he did a great job encouraging participation in class. He's also so kind and clearly cares about forming strong relationships with his students: on the first day of section, he already knew all our names when we walked in. I hope goes on to be a professor later in life any student would be lucky to have him.
1658056	Sander is probably the best TA I've had at Yale and one of the most knowledgeable people I have met. He was always eager to answer questions and made the class a really positive experience for me. Despite not feeling as prepared for the class as my peers in section at first, going to his office hours helped me understand the material and engage with the course.
1659419	Excellent instructor. He brought a clear passion for the subject that transferred to us. Highly recommend.
1659426	I really enjoyed having Sander as a TA. He was extremely knowledgeable on the topics and I was captivated during each section. He also was far more direct about my status in the course than past TA's, which I really appreciated.
1659431	He is simply an amazing TF, able to explain a variety of extremely complex concepts in such a simple and effective manner. May be the best TF I have had in my Yale experience thus far.
1659450	The highlight of the class for me. If I could change one thing about this class, I would have made Sander the lecturer. Sander has a unique ability to distill what comes across as incredibly challenging, opaque political ideas into easy to digest, interesting tidbits. I greatly enjoyed section. I felt that nearly all my learning came from section. I would go so far as to say that Sander was the greatest TF I have had the pleasure of having throughout my last four years at Yale.
1659463	Amazing TF. Led excellently structured sections that tied together themes of the course and the readings. Very helpful and accessible in terms of answering questions and organized multiple review sessions in advance of both the midterm and the final. Very knowledgeable about the course material.
1659488	Sander is by far one of the best TFs I've ever had here! Not only was he highly organized and competent in explaining the readings but he also guided us in engaging with the arguments and contextualizing our lecture content in the broader economic history of capitalism. He was excellent at encouraging conversation and was overall a great person. He was very patient and stayed late after many sections to answer my questions and I do not think I would have gotten as much out of this class if he was not around.
1659532	I don't usually write course evals for TAs, but I'll make an exception for Sander bc he's honestly been one of the best TAs I've had here at Yale. He made every possible effort for us to understand this content and deeply engage with the material. The countless review sessions before the exam that he led were very very helpful. The lecture was often very confusing but everything made sense once Sander explained it in section. He's also made section very inclusive and engaging! always looked forward to it.
1659550	Sander is a great TF and makes a section that adds a lot to the experience in the class. He is able to lead the discussion in the class well and generalize the material and learned topics into the models that are applicable even outside of the studied cases. Sander is also really approachable and helpful.
1659602	Sander was a fantastic TF. He did a great job leading discussion -- everyone was always able to make their voice heard, and he did a nice job encouraging participation from students who were less outspoken. He knows the material and has a knack for explaining it clearly and concisely. His office hours were also a joy, and I appreciate the opportunity to get to know more about him and his research.
1659664	One of the best teaching fellows I've had at Yale. Incredibly knowledgeable yet able to communicate ideas clearly.

Term Spring 2023	Course EP&E 363 01/GLBL 287 01/PLSC 387 01/SOCY 230 01 - Capitalism and Crisis	Primary Dept PLSC	Primary Division Social Sciences	Enrolled: 53 Responded: 48
Instructors Mares, Isabela (P)				

#10 Summarize the strengths and weaknesses of the Teaching Fellow. In what ways was their teaching effective and in what ways could their teaching be improved?

Instructor(s): Trubowitz, Alexander

Responses for Instructor: 18
Declined to Answer Question: 4

Respondent	Answer
1659698	Sander was the best TF I have had at Yale. He was extremely well prepared for every section, knowing exactly how to tie students individual reading responses in with the content/discussion. In a class where lectures did not have a lot of common themes, ending the week with section was the perfect way to have everything tie together. Also super knowledgeable about the subject, but whats more important is that he could make and present his knowledge in a presentable way for students.
1659981	Sander was a fantastic teaching fellow. His knowledge of the subject is unbelievable and he is skilled at explaining difficult concepts to students encountering them for the first time. He paid great attention to all of the students and read all of our discussion posts before section, and I appreciate that he took lots of time out of his day to hold review sessions on several occasions for students who wanted extra practice for exams.
1660138	Sander was a fantastic Teaching Fellow - extremely well structured sections that facilitate my understanding of the course content + very available for questions/help.
1671057	Sander Trubowitz was genuinely one of the best teaching fellows I have had at Yale, and I think will have. He has a great mastery of the course, knows what is important to know about, and was very efficient in communicating all of this and supporting our learning of the concepts and case studies. Every section was really engaging, built on the course material in interesting ways whilst tying multiple aspects of the course material together that lecture did not have time to do. Review sessions were amazing and really. Without Sander, I believe I would not have enjoyed this course nearly as much, wouldnt have been able to bring all the concepts together in such a concise and wonderfully comprehensive way, and wouldnt remember these models after the course had ended. Truly, truly, an amazing teaching fellow.
1671612	Good classroom presence, good understanding of material and ability to explain course concepts clearly.
1677366	Best Discussion Section I have had at Yale. Reaches out to students. Advises students and gives them direction. Leads a very structured and purposeful study sessions and discussion sections. Very engaging and encourages active participations. Makes a point to reference our answers to discussions posts and relate current events to class.

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Spring 2023	EP&E 363 01/GLBL 287 01/PLSC 387 01/SOCY 230 01 - Capitalism and Crisis	PLSC	Social Sciences	Responded: 48
Instructors				
Mares, Isabela (P)				

#11 What is your overall assessment of the Teaching Fellow?
Instructor(s): Trubowitz, Alexander

Responses for Instructor: 21
Declined to Answer Question: 1

Average and Standard Deviation			
Question Average	Dept	Div	School
4.8 ±0.7	4.5 ±0.9	4.3 ±1.0	4.3 ±1.0

Choice Label	Counts
poor	0
fair	1
good	0
very good	1
excellent	19

Term Spring 2021	Course GLBL 287 01/PLSC 387 01/SOCY 230 01 - Capitalism and Crisis	Primary Dept PLSC	Primary Division Social Sciences	Enrolled: 33 Responded: 27
Instructors Mares, Isabela (P)				

The Faculty of Arts and Sciences Steering Committee requests that readers of student course evaluations for AY 2020-21 keep in mind the extraordinary teaching conditions of this academic year, among them faculty and student adjustment to new pedagogies and technologies demanded by remote course delivery; disruptions to faculty routines for balancing research, teaching, and service; and disruptions to childcare, schooling, elder care, and other faculty obligations outside of their work at Yale.

#11 Summarize the strengths and weaknesses of the Teaching Fellow. In what ways was their teaching effective and in what ways could their teaching be improved?

Instructor(s): Trubowitz, Alexander

Responses for Instructor: 10
Declined to Answer Question: 3

Respondent	Answer
1485192	Approachable, good job at summarizing content from lecturers, could improve a little at facilitating discussion in section but also can't really be blamed by that (early morning on Friday is deadly).
1491368	I was originally unsure about taking this course until I had my first section with Sander; he did a really amazing job of just explaining the content and clarifying it to us during sections and I genuinely feel my success in this class was a result of his guidance and his help during sections. A lot of the times, lectures left me a little confused but Sander often brought in outside information and summarized ideas through his own powerpoints and this helped me a lot personally when it came to truly understanding the material. Sander was also super encouraging when it came to speaking up and our contributions in section and I was also really appreciative of that. Overall, one of the biggest strengths of the whole course for me was having Sander as my TA and I recommend continuing to use the powerpoints and outside information during section to help students understand what was discussed in class.
1493888	Sander is definitely one of the best TFs I've had at Yale. He had been very approachable since day one. During discussion sections, his content review helped me strengthen my understanding of lecture materials, and his slides were always super clear, which helped me greatly when I was reviewing for exams. He is very knowledgeable and created a discussion section environment where we felt encouraged to chime in and ask questions whenever. Sander also actively collected student feedback and tried his best to tailor sections to our preferences. I enjoyed participating in section each week, even in a COVID semester.
1493988	Sander did his best to facilitate a good discussion during section even when that is extremely hard over zoom. He combined lecture slides and open discussion which was a good balance. One thing he can improve is asking more conceptual questions during section rather than content based questions on the readings or lectures.
1496381	The sections were good to catch up on the week's readings and material but sometimes it would have been nice with more student engagement.
1498137	Alexander was extremely thorough and considerate in his teaching. He cared about cultivating discussion and receiving questions from students. He often went out of his way to clarify and condense course material for students through multimedia presentations.
1499217	Great TA who had a superb balance of PowerPoint materials and organic conversation during sections.
1505734	Sander is great! He made sections interesting and relevant and was willing to answer all and any questions. He also did a great job encouraging people who might be hesitant to speak in class and offered thorough reviews if people were confused.
1506209	Sander was a very good TF; I felt really comfortable going to him with any questions and was a joy to just talk to!

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Instructor(s): Trubowitz, Alexander

Responses for Instructor: 10
Declined to Answer Question: 3

Respondent	Answer
1507967	Sander was amazing! Definitely one of the best TFs I have had at Yale, and I would have dropped this course if discussion sections were not so great. He did a great job of using section to dissect readings and complicated concepts from lecture, which was much appreciated given that lectures were difficult to get through. He read discussion posts before section and did a good job of keeping everyone involved in section by asking them about their discussion posts instead of just cold-calling. He was very approachable and always responded to emails and questions in a timely fashion. 10/10!!

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#12 What is your overall assessment of the Teaching Fellow?

Instructor(s): Trubowitz, Alexander

Responses for Instructor: 12
Declined to Answer Question: 1

Average and Standard Deviation

Question Average	Dept	Div	School
4.8 ±0.5	4.4 ±0.9	4.3 ±0.9	4.3 ±0.9

Choice Label	Counts
poor	0
fair	0
good	0
very good	3
excellent	9

Term	Course	Primary Dept	Primary Division	Enrolled: 92
Fall 2020	PLSC 116 01 - Comparative Politics	PLSC	Social Sciences	Responded: 77
Instructors				
Khan, Sarah (P)				

The Faculty of Arts and Sciences Steering Committee requests that readers of student course evaluations for AY 2020-21 keep in mind the extraordinary teaching conditions of this academic year, among them faculty and student adjustment to new pedagogies and technologies demanded by remote course delivery; disruptions to faculty routines for balancing research, teaching, and service; and disruptions to childcare, schooling, elder care, and other faculty obligations outside of their work at Yale.

#11 Summarize the strengths and weaknesses of the Teaching Fellow. In what ways was their teaching effective and in what ways could their teaching be improved?

Instructor(s): Trubowitz, Alexander

Responses for Instructor: 13
Declined to Answer Question: 12

Respondent	Answer
1448216	Sander was great. Really knowledgeable and facilitated great conversations. The only weakness is that he often did not set expectations for written assignments, so it was easy to lose points on subjective matters without really feeling like my writing was improved from the feedback.
1448860	He's very knowledgeable and I appreciate his efforts in leading our section this semester. It was a productive conversation every week.
1448968	Ran discussion section very effectively. Felt that he involved everyone well and facilitated a thought provoking and engaging discussion consistently.
1452247	Sander was a very good TF. He let me meet with him outside of class and provided extra feedback on my work. The discussion sections were also open/respectful environments. I also appreciated how he would follow up on things discussed in section over email if we ran out of time. Sections were a highlight.
1452838	Strengths: very knowledgeable, great brand of humor, and clear control of concepts. Also did a good job of pushing us in section to come to conclusions of our own or to question particular authors from the syllabi.
1459431	Alexander was fantastic. He put a lot of effort into the discussion section and did a great job facilitating our understanding of the course concepts.
1466237	Sander did an excellent job leading discussions, engaging students, and making a great section experience.
1467438	Sander put extra time in every discussion section to make sure we understood the readings. His feedback on our work was amazingly clear and extensive.
1471358	I really couldn't have asked for a better Teaching Fellow. He was incredibly approachable and responded to emails very quickly. I felt incredibly comfortable emailing him with any problems I was having, and he would quickly email me back with an understanding reply, prioritizing personal health over the timeliness of papers. He allowed me the time and space to balance the chaos of the pandemic and this course, which was more appreciated than I could describe. He was also ready to shift the structure of discussion sections so that they were more comfortable for students, which I also really appreciated. I genuinely can't imagine any way his teaching could be improved. He encouraged us to participate and think critically while allowing us to focus on our health and well being. 11 out of 10 stars.
1473961	Sander's familiarity with a diverse set of political systems suited him well in this course. For example, when discussing political violence and suppression, his knowledge of Argentina enhanced my understanding of the topic. Moreover, he was always open to discussion after section, which really suited my schedule since I had another class during our regular office hours slot. Sander could benefit from a less demeaning style of engagement. What was meant as sarcasm could have been interpreted as belittling. All in all, Sander's section was enjoyable.

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Declined to Answer Question: 12

Respondent	Answer
1473979	Sander was a great teaching fellow, and I feel that he was the best in getting me out of my shell in my first semester and first discussion section at Yale. While I was often nervous or unsure about speaking up or sharing my thoughts, he created a comfortable environment, and, although sometimes unpopular with some people, I appreciated his direct callouts that made me speak up. He ensured that everyone was given equal opportunity to contribute to the conversation, and was always well equipped to answer any questions we had. He also was not shy about challenging our propositions or our ideas on a certain weekly topic, which not only furthered the conversation but made us think differently about the material. Also, I found his feedback very detailed and incredibly helpful on each assignment, which made my writing in the class much stronger by the end.
1473992	My TF gave really amazing feedback on my papers and facilitated great discussion sections. Overall, he was a very, very good TF.
1474012	Sander was a great TF and made this course really memorable for me. He made sure that everyone participated in section and really took the time to read and reference our discussion posts. He was also super accessible for office hours and was always willing to meet after class if we had any remaining questions. He cared that we learned, even over virtual learning, and that meant a lot!

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#12 What is your overall assessment of the Teaching Fellow?

Instructor(s): Trubowitz, Alexander

Responses for Instructor: 20
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good	3
very good	4
excellent	13